

Learning & Development, Professional Certification, and Tuition Assistance

Policy No. LND-POL-501 · Version 3.0 · Effective January 1, 2026 · Owner: Chief Learning Officer

1. Growth Philosophy and Career Framework

Cymbal Corp fosters a culture of relentless learning and technical excellence. Rooted in the **70-20-10 learning model**, we empower employees to expand their professional mastery through real-world stretch assignments (70%), mentorship and cross-functional guilds (20%), and sponsored continuing education and formal certifications (10%).

2. Annual Individual Professional Development Stipend

Every regular full-time employee with at least 90 days of continuous service is allotted an annual individual development stipend of **\$2,500 USD per calendar year**.

Eligible expenses reimbursable under this stipend include:

- Registration fees for approved technical, leadership, and industry conferences.
- Professional association memberships (ACM, IEEE, SHRM, AICPA, etc.).
- Technical reference books, technical journals, and specialized self-paced online curricula.
- Examination fees for recognized professional credentials (GCP, AWS, CISSP, PMP, CFA, etc.).

Program Element	Annual Benefit Ceiling	Payment Mechanism	Prerequisite Criteria
Annual Individual Stipend	\$2,500 USD per calendar year	Expense reimbursement via Concur	Full-time status, ≥ 90 days tenure
Enterprise Sponsored Certs	100% Fully Covered (Outside stipend)	Corporate voucher direct bill	VP / Functional Head recommendation
Higher Ed Tuition (Sec 127)	Up to \$5,250 USD annually tax-free	Direct bursar / post-term payout	≥ 12 months tenure, Grade B or higher
Exam Retake Coverage	One retake covered if score ≥ 80%	Deducted from individual stipend	Passing credential on second attempt

3. Reimbursement Procedure and Form LND-201

Reimbursement claims must be submitted within **45 calendar days** of course or credential completion via Concur using **Form LND-201 (Certification & Training Reimbursement)**. Claims must include itemized paid receipts and official certificates of completion or credential score reports.

4. Higher Education Tuition Assistance Program (IRS Section 127)

Under IRC Section 127, Cymbal provides up to **\$5,250 per calendar year** in tax-free tuition reimbursement for accredited undergraduate and graduate coursework aligned with the employee's career progression at Cymbal.

Program Requirement	Standard Threshold	Operational Detail
Tenure Eligibility	12 months continuous full-time service	Measured prior to academic term start date
Performance Requirement	Rating 3 (Consistently Meets) or above	Most recent annual calibration cycle
Institution Standard	Regionally accredited college or university	Non-accredited institutions ineligible
Academic Standard	Minimum grade of 'B' (3.0 GPA) or 'Pass'	Grades below 'B' ineligible for reimbursement
Pre-Enrollment Approval	Mandatory filing via Form LND-302	Must be submitted 30 days prior to term start

5. Post-Completion Retention Agreement and Repayment Covenant

To protect organizational investments in advanced degrees, employees receiving Tuition Assistance agree to a **12-month service retention covenant** beginning on the official completion date of the subsidized academic course:

- **Departure within 0 to 6 months:** Employee must repay **100%** of tuition assistance disbursed for that course.
- **Departure within 7 to 12 months:** Employee must repay **50%** of tuition assistance disbursed for that course.
- **Departure after 12 months:** No repayment obligation is incurred.

Repayment obligations are waived exclusively in instances of company-initiated separation due to organizational restructuring or reduction-in-force (RIF).

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